

# Pointing the domain at the new site

How to move `bellinghambarbershack.com` off the Wix site and onto the new Next.js build on Vercel, without breaking the shop's email.

## Read this first: Wix is not just hosting the site. It is running the DNS.

The domain's nameservers are **ns10.wixdns.net** and **ns11.wixdns.net**. That means every DNS record for the domain lives inside Wix — including the **MX records that carry the shop's email through Google Workspace**, the SPF record, and a Google site-verification record.

So this is not a one-switch job. If the Wix subscription lapses, or the nameservers are moved without copying those records across first, **the website and the email both stop**. Email outages are far more damaging than a website outage, and far harder to notice quickly.

Everything in this document is built around not letting that happen.

## What is on the domain right now

Captured live from public DNS on 27 August 2026. Take your own copy before changing anything — this table is your rollback.

| RECORD       | CURRENT VALUE                                                         | WHAT IT DOES                                  | ACTION            |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Nameservers  | ns10.wixdns.net<br>ns11.wixdns.net                                    | Wix answers all DNS for the domain            | Depends on route  |
| A (apex)     | 185.230.63.171<br>185.230.63.186<br>185.230.63.107                    | Points the bare domain at Wix's servers       | Repoint to Vercel |
| CNAME (www)  | cdn1.wixdns.net                                                       | Points www at Wix's CDN                       | Repoint to Vercel |
| MX × 5       | aspmx.l.google.com (10)<br>alt1 (20) alt2 (30)<br>alt3 (40) alt4 (50) | Delivers the shop's email to Google Workspace | DO NOT TOUCH      |
| TXT (SPF)    | v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all                                   | Stops the shop's mail being marked as spam    | DO NOT TOUCH      |
| TXT (verify) | google-site-verification=WUYDttWg...                                  | Proves domain ownership to Google             | DO NOT TOUCH      |

### The email records are the whole risk

Those five MX records and the SPF record are what make mail to the shop work. They have nothing to do with the website and must survive the cutover completely untouched. Verify them **after** every DNS change you make, not just at the end.

Useful side note for the build: because mail already routes through Google Workspace, setting up the proper **jared@bellinghambarbershack.com** mailbox the spec asks for (open registry item #2) is likely a matter of adding a user or alias in the existing Google Admin console, not standing up new mail infrastructure. Confirm before publishing the address anywhere.

## STAGE 01

## Before you touch DNS

Every one of these should be true before the cutover window opens. None of them involve the domain, so all of them can be done calmly, in advance, with the Wix site still happily serving visitors.

- [ ] The new site is deployed on Vercel and fully working on its temporary `.vercel.app` address. Click through it properly — every nav item, the price board, the booking embed, the contact form.
- [ ] `NEXT_PUBLIC_WEB3FORMS_ACCESS_KEY` is set in Vercel's environment variables and the contact form actually delivers a test message. Without it the form still renders but tells people to phone instead.
- [ ] The legacy URL inventory is done — see the note below. This is the one genuinely outstanding piece of homework.
- [ ] Redirects for every legacy URL are in `next.config.ts` and tested on the `.vercel.app` address.
- [ ] You have the Wix account login, and you know whether the domain was *bought through Wix* or bought elsewhere and connected. Check the registrar's site if unsure — it changes who you talk to if something goes wrong.
- [ ] You have access to the Google Workspace admin and to the Google Business Profile.
- [ ] You have saved a copy of the DNS table on page 1.
- [ ] TTL on the A and CNAME records has been lowered to 300 seconds, at least 24 hours before the flip, so a rollback takes minutes instead of a day.

### The one piece of homework still outstanding

The build spec (ticket 0.3) calls for a catalogue of every live Wix URL with its redirect target. That has not been done, and it cannot be done from inside the build — it needs someone to look at the live site. It matters because any legacy URL you miss becomes a 404 the day you cut over, and any inbound link or search ranking pointing at it is wasted.

**How to do it in ten minutes:** open `bellinghambarbershack.com/sitemap.xml` in a browser and copy out every URL listed. Cross-check against Wix's own page list in the editor, and against Google Search Console's Pages report if the property exists. Write each old URL next to the new page it should land on.

The redirect map currently in the repo assumes the old site had only Home, Blog and Contact. If that is right, the work is nearly done already — the blog redirect is in place and it correctly kills the three unedited Wix demo posts. Confirm it rather than assume it.

### A judgement call worth making on purpose

The new site currently has **46 routes live of roughly 82** planned. It is perfectly launchable — it is already vastly more site than the three-page Wix template — but it is not finished, and several clusters are hubs with no spokes behind them yet.

Launching now starts the clock on Google discovering the new structure, which is worth real money over a quarter. Waiting means launching more complete. Either is defensible; the point is to decide it deliberately rather than drift into it.

## STAGE 02

## Pick a route

There are two honest ways to do this, and the right one depends on whether the goal is simply to go live, or to stop paying Wix altogether.

|                     | ROUTE A – REPOINT INSIDE WIX                                                          | ROUTE B – MOVE THE NAMESERVERS                                                                   |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What you do         | Leave Wix answering DNS. Change only the A and CNAME records so they point at Vercel. | Rebuild the full DNS zone somewhere else (registrar or Cloudflare), then switch the nameservers. |
| Email risk          | Very low. You never touch the MX or TXT records.                                      | Real. You are recreating the mail records by hand and a typo breaks email.                       |
| Time to live        | Minutes to a couple of hours.                                                         | Up to 48 hours for nameservers to settle.                                                        |
| Can you cancel Wix? | No. Wix still runs the DNS, so the subscription has to stay.                          | Yes. This is the only way to leave Wix completely.                                               |
| Rollback            | Easy. Put the old A and CNAME values back.                                            | Slower. Nameserver changes take time to propagate both ways.                                     |

### Recommended: do it in two steps, not one

**Run Route A first.** Flip the website over with essentially no chance of touching email, and let the new site prove itself in the wild for a couple of weeks. The shop is live on the new build the same afternoon.

**Then run Route B as a separate, unhurried job** when you actually want to cancel the Wix subscription. By then nothing depends on getting it done in a hurry, and you can move the mail records carefully with the website already safely elsewhere.

Doing both at once means that if anything breaks, you will not know whether the cause was the website change or the DNS move. Separating them means you always know which change to undo.

## STAGE 03

## Route A — repoint the records inside Wix

This keeps Wix as the DNS host and changes only where the website traffic goes. Email is untouched throughout.

- 01** In Vercel, open the project, go to **Settings, then Domains** and add `bellinghambarbershack.com`. Add `www.bellinghambarbershack.com` as well and let Vercel redirect one to the other — pick whichever form you want as the canonical one and keep it consistent with what is in the build.
- 02** Vercel will show you the exact DNS values it wants: an **A record for the apex** and a **CNAME for www**. **Read them off the dashboard rather than trusting any value written down here** — hosting providers do change them. At the time of writing Vercel uses `76.76.21.21` for the A record and `cname.vercel-dns.com` for the CNAME.
- 03** In Wix, open the domain's **DNS records** screen (in the domain settings, not the site editor). If Wix will not let you edit the A record because the domain is connected to a published Wix site, disconnect the domain from that site first. Wix's menu wording shifts between account types — you are looking for advanced DNS or custom records.
- 04** **Delete the three Wix A records** on the apex and replace them with the single A record Vercel gave you.
- 05** **Change the www CNAME** from `cdn1.wixdns.net` to the Vercel CNAME target.
- 06** **Change nothing else**. Leave all five MX records, the SPF record and the google-site-verification record exactly as they are. If Wix warns that removing records may affect your site, that is expected — it means the website, not the email.
- 07** Save, then wait. With a lowered TTL this is usually minutes. Move to the verification checklist on the next page and do not skip the email checks.
- 08** Once the new site is confirmed live and serving over HTTPS, **unpublish the Wix site** — genuinely unpublish it, do not simply hide it or remove it from navigation. Two live copies of the same business competing in search is a real problem, not a cosmetic one.

## STAGE 04

## Route B — move the nameservers off Wix

Do this when you want to stop paying Wix entirely. The order matters enormously: you build the new zone completely **before** you switch anything.

- 01 Decide where DNS will live. The domain's registrar is the simplest answer. Cloudflare is free and better, and is worth it if anyone is comfortable with it.
- 02 **Write down every existing record first.** The table on page 1 is your starting point, but re-check it live on the day — something may have been added since.
- 03 In the new DNS provider, create the zone and **enter every record before switching the nameservers**: the Vercel A record, the www CNAME, all five Google MX records with their correct priorities (10, 20, 30, 40, 50), the SPF TXT record, and the google-site-verification TXT record.
- 04 **Check the MX priorities twice.** This is the single most common way people break their own email during a migration. Ten, twenty, thirty, forty, fifty, in that order, against aspmx / alt1 / alt2 / alt3 / alt4.
- 05 Only once the zone is complete and re-read, change the nameservers at the registrar away from ns10.wixdns.net and ns11.wixdns.net to the new provider's.
- 06 Wait for propagation — up to 48 hours, though usually much less. During this window some people will hit the old Wix answer and some the new one. That is normal and is exactly why the mail records had to be identical in both.
- 07 Run the full verification checklist. **Send a real email to the shop and reply to it from the shop's address** — both directions, tested, not assumed.
- 08 Give it a clear week of working email before cancelling the Wix subscription. Cancelling is the one step in this entire document that cannot be undone.

### Do not cancel Wix on the same day you move the nameservers

If the subscription lapses while anything still depends on Wix's nameservers, the domain can stop resolving entirely — website and email together, with no quick way back. Leave a comfortable gap, confirm mail is flowing both ways, and only then close the account.

## STAGE 05

## Verify — in this order

Work down the list. The email checks are not optional and not last for a reason — do them as soon as DNS has moved.

- [ ] **Email still arrives.** Send a message from an outside account to the shop's address and confirm it lands.
- [ ] **Email still sends.** Reply from the shop's address to an outside account and confirm it arrives and is not flagged as spam.
- [ ] **MX records unchanged.** Re-check that all five Google MX records are present with the right priorities.
- [ ] The bare domain loads the new site, over HTTPS, with a valid certificate and no browser warning. Vercel issues the certificate automatically but it can take a few minutes after DNS resolves.
- [ ] The www version resolves too, and redirects to the canonical form rather than serving a second copy of the site.
- [ ] /blog and any old blog post URL return a **301** to the new site — not a 404, and not a chain of several hops.
- [ ] Every URL from the legacy inventory lands somewhere real.
- [ ] /sitemap.xml loads and lists 46 URLs.
- [ ] /robots.txt loads and does not block the site.
- [ ] Spot-check on an actual phone, not just a desktop browser window made narrow.
- [ ] The booking embed loads and the contact form delivers a real test message.
- [ ] The Wix site is unpublished.

### If something is wrong: rolling back

**Route A rollback** is quick. Put the three original Wix A records back on the apex and set the www CNAME to `cdn1.wixdns.net`, then republish the Wix site. With a lowered TTL you are back within minutes.

**Route B rollback** means pointing the nameservers back at `ns10.wixdns.net` and `ns11.wixdns.net`, and waiting again for propagation. Slower, which is the main argument for doing Route A first.

**If email breaks**, treat it as the emergency and fix it before anything else. Restore the five MX records and the SPF record to exactly the values on page 1. Mail that bounces during an outage is usually retried by the sending server for a day or more, so fixing it quickly generally means nothing is actually lost.

## STAGE 06

## After the flip

The cutover is not finished when the site loads. This is the part that decides whether the new structure actually earns anything in search.

- [ ] **Google Search Console** — make sure a property exists for the domain and is verified. The google-site-verification record already on the domain suggests one may exist already; check before creating a duplicate.
- [ ] **Submit the sitemap** at /sitemap.xml in Search Console.
- [ ] **Update the Google Business Profile website field** to the new URL. This is the highest-value single field in the whole list — it is where most local traffic actually starts.
- [ ] **Consider deep-linking the GBP services** to the matching new service pages rather than pointing everything at the homepage.
- [ ] **Update the top directories** — Yelp, Facebook, Instagram bio, Vagaro, Square, Apple Maps, Bing Places, and any local Bellingham listings. Use the exact same name, address and phone as the site footer, character for character.
- [ ] **Post the \$12 Tuesdays update to the Google Business Profile** once the programme page is live and linkable.

## The 48-hour watch

For two days after the flip, check daily:

- [ ] Search Console coverage report for new crawl errors or a spike in 404s.
- [ ] That the redirects still behave — a redirect that works on day one can break when a config is redeployed.
- [ ] Branded search for “Barber Shack Bellingham” still returns the site, and returns the *new* one.
- [ ] That mail is still flowing, morning and evening.
- [ ] Vercel's deployment log for build failures if anyone pushes a change.

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## Two things worth remembering

**Email is the fragile part, not the website.** If the site goes down for an hour, a few people see an error page. If email goes down for an hour, bookings and enquiries vanish silently and nobody finds out for days. Every judgement call in this document leans toward protecting the mail records.

**Nothing here has to happen on the same day.** The two-step approach — flip the website first, leave Wix's DNS alone, deal with the subscription weeks later — converts one risky afternoon into two calm ones.

DNS values in this document were read live from public DNS on 27 August 2026 and should be re-checked on the day. Vercel's required record values must be read from the Vercel dashboard at the time of cutover, not copied from here. The legacy URL inventory could not be captured from the build environment and remains the one outstanding prerequisite.